Plan a circle: “The Yellow Wallpaper”

Charlotte Perkins Gilman (1892) · public-domain short story · grades 10–12 · ~1 week / two meetings. Rights: Public domain.

Kit section 5 (group agreement & calendar) filled in for one text — a finished plan students see before writing their own. ***Tinted italic*** = sample answers.

Preview note: Preview for mental illness and controlling medical/gender dynamics; plan support.

Text, group, and target

Text / author / edition	***“The Yellow Wallpaper” — Charlotte Perkins Gilman (1892). Public-domain short story.***
Group / period / dates	***Rosa’s group · Period __ · Meetings ___ & ___***
Grade / TEKS target (p. 3)	English III · §110.38 — 6(A): relationships among literary elements; 5(C,D): analytic commentary and summary; 1(D): student-led discussion.
Learning intention	We are learning to explain how the setting and the “rest cure” reveal a theme about autonomy and gender.
Success criteria	I bring one open question, cite two details with locations, respond to a peer, and name how my thinking changed.

Reading map & calendar

Chunk	Read through	Meeting date · leader
1	***Arrival at the house, the wallpaper introduced, and John’s control.***	***Tue · Leader: Rosa***
2	***The narrator’s growing fixation through the final “creeping.”***	***Thu · Leader: Will***

Members & first-meeting jobs (p. 7 roles)

Member	First job	Rotates to (next meeting)
Rosa	***Questioner***	***Summarizer***
Will	***Summarizer***	***Clarifier***
Tara	***Clarifier***	***Evidence tracker***
Ben	***Predictor***	***Questioner***

Text-specific discussion questions (open — more than one answer)

- **Predict:** The narrator is told to rest and not write — what will forced idleness do to her? What clue hints at it?
- **Question:** Why might Gilman make the wallpaper’s “woman” appear only to the narrator?
- **Clarify:** What does the narrator mean when she “gets out at last”?
- **Summarize:** Trace how her view of the wallpaper changes across the story, without opinion.
- **Interpret the theme:** How do the setting and John’s control reveal a theme about women’s autonomy? Use two details.

> **Optional Jigsaw lenses (p. 4):** ***Character*** (the narrator and John) · ***Symbol*** (the wallpaper and its “woman”) · ***Point of view*** (the journal, increasingly unreliable) · ***Theme*** (autonomy and gender) · ***Language*** (the fragmented entries).

Sample 3–2–1 notes: Tara, symbol lens

Name: Tara · Home group: Rosa's group · Period __ · Meetings ___ & ___ · Section: "The Yellow Wallpaper," Chunk 2 · Expert lens: Symbol

> **What a finished prep looks like.** Kit section 6 / Organizer A completed for one reader, so students can compare their notes to a strong model.

Questions ***Is her "freedom" at the end real or tragic?*** ***How much does John cause her breakdown?***	**3 · Important ideas** ***1. The wallpaper repels the narrator, then fascinates her.*** ***2. She comes to see a trapped woman behind the pattern.*** ***3. She tears the paper to "free" that woman.***
Vocabulary ***atrocious = shockingly bad.*** ***arabesque = an ornate, winding pattern.***	**2 · Supporting details** ***1. She describes the pattern's "bars" (middle). → Suggests confinement.*** ***2. She creeps over the fainted John (ending). → A grim reversal of who controls whom.***

1 · Summary in my own words

A woman confined for a "rest cure" fixates on the wallpaper, identifies with a trapped figure in it, and breaks down while claiming freedom.

Bring to the circle

My interpretation: ***Denying a person voice and work can destroy the mind it claims to heal.***
Synthesis (two lenses): ***The wallpaper (symbol) carries the theme: the trapped woman mirrors the narrator's caged autonomy. Text points: the "bars" (Chunk 2) and the final creeping.***
After discussion: ***My thinking became clearer once the group compared evidence.***

TEKS evidence: 6(C,D) supported inference; 7(A) theme through characters/events; 1(D) response to a peer. · Pair with the PlotPoint "The Yellow Wallpaper" room.